Two Homes, One County

A Data-Driven Home Search for William Rodriguez



King County Housing Market Analysis · Sales from May 2014 – May 2015

William Rodriguez — buyer, household of 2

Meet the Client



City Home

- Needs to move fast
- Wants a central location



Country Home

- Best possible timing to buy
- Open to (actually prefers) non-renovated homes

What We Looked At

21,597

home sales analyzed

12 months

May 2014 – May 2015

King County

Seattle & surrounding area

Sale records were joined against county property details — size, condition, location, and renovation history — for every transaction in the window.

Three Questions We Set Out to Answer



Does location drive price?

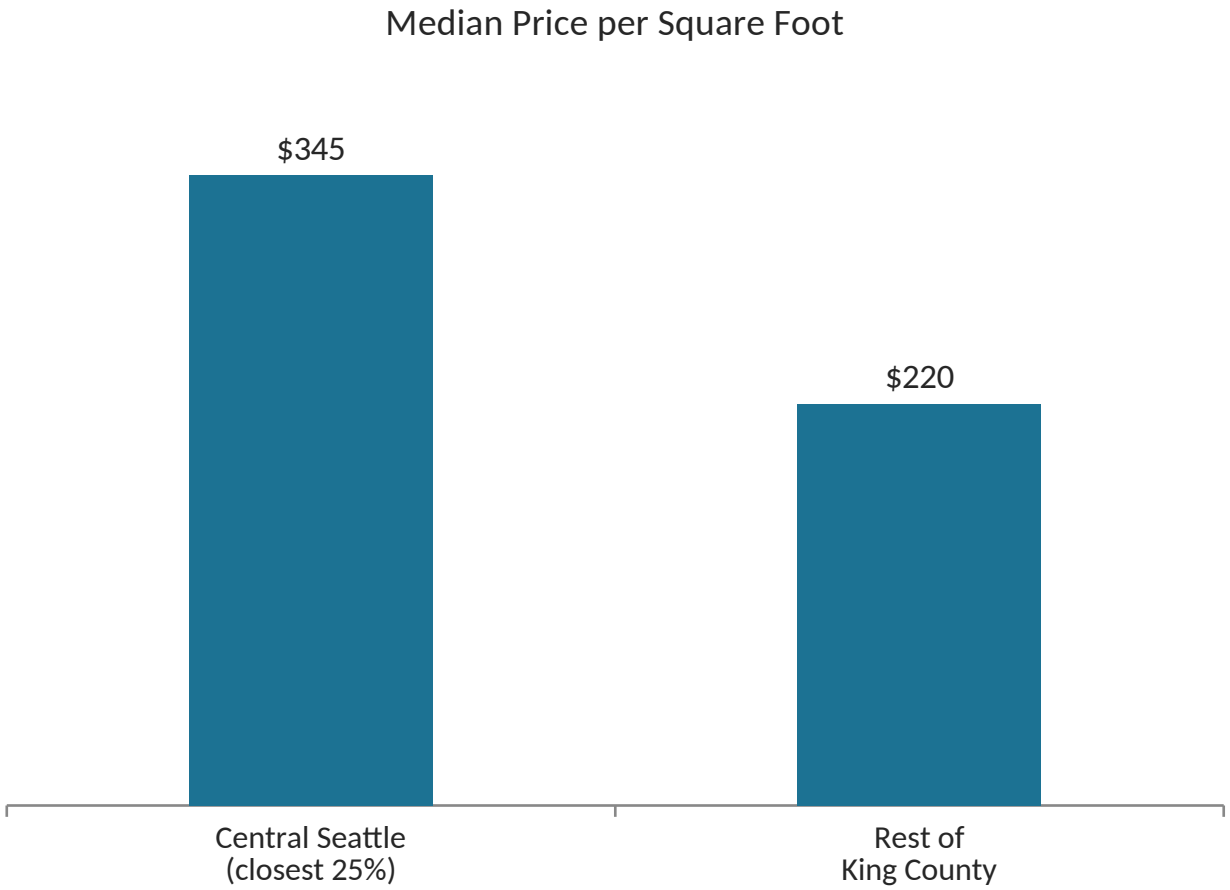


Does renovation status matter?



Is there a best time to buy?

Location Commands a Premium

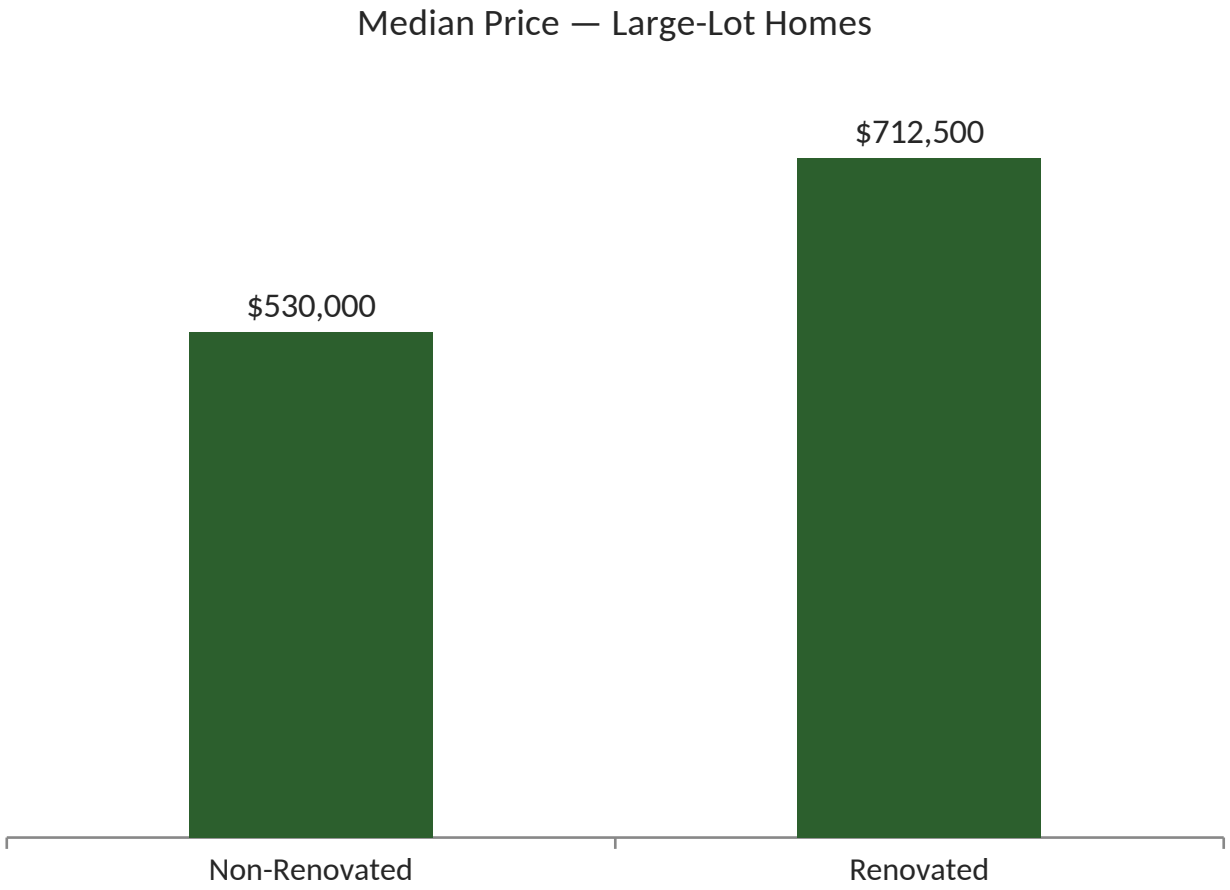


57%

more per square foot within ~6 miles of downtown Seattle

Large-lot “country” homes don’t sell for less overall — but they do cost less per square foot of living space, since the buyer is paying for land, not finished floor area.

Non-Renovated Homes Cost Less — By Design



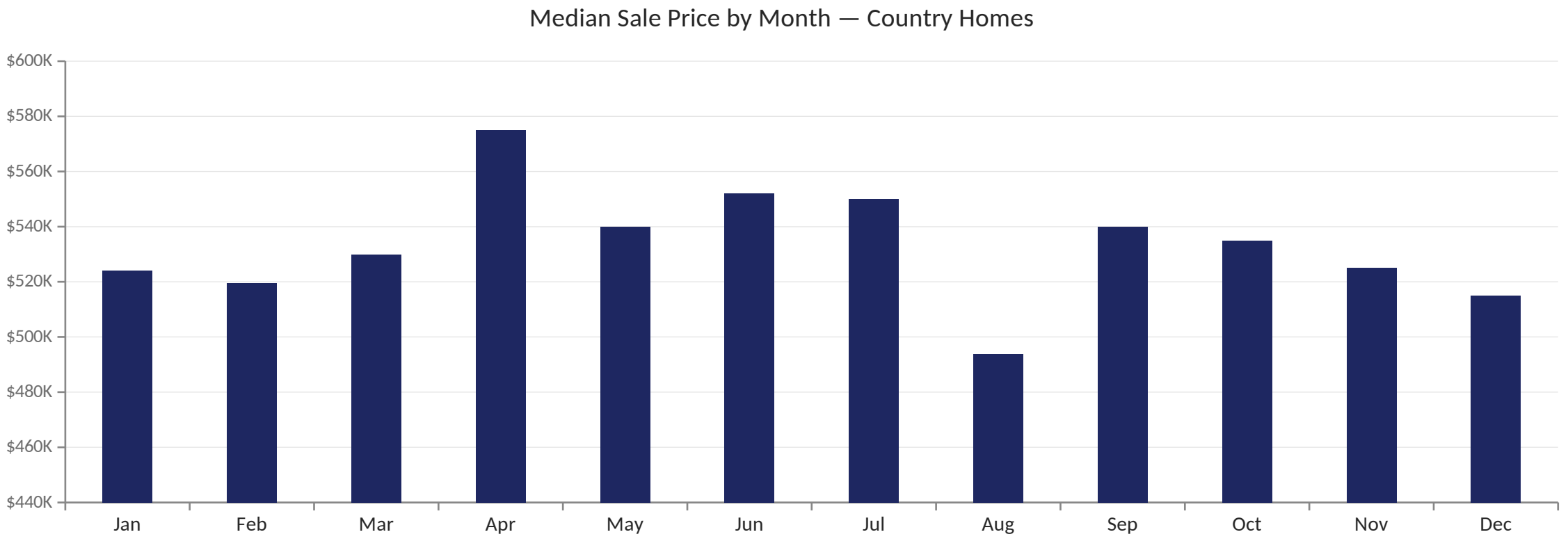
97%

of King County homes have no renovation on record

Among large-lot properties, renovated homes carry a ~34% premium. Non-renovated homes aren’t a compromise — they’re the norm, and they’re the cheaper option.

When You Buy Determines What You Pay

Country homes specifically — city homes follow a different, later-year pattern.



Aug – $493,725

cheapest median price for country homes

May – 604 sales

most country-home listings to choose from

For the City Home → Zip 98118

7.9 km

from downtown Seattle — the closest of the high-turnover zips

507 sales

in the 12-month window — highest turnover among affordable central zips

$367,500

median price — the most affordable of that group

98103, 98115, and 98117 are strong second choices if 98118 doesn't work out.
Filter to 1–3 bedrooms — plenty for a household of 2, and it avoids a ~41% size premium.

For the Country Home → Zip 98010 or 98014

30+ km

from downtown — genuinely rural, not just “outside city limits”

68–85%

of homes in these zips are large-lot — real country character

$360K–$415K

median price — well below the county median

Lean into non-renovated listings here — they’re the majority of homes and meaningfully cheaper.

Timing the Country Home

Buy in August

Lowest median price of the year for country homes — $493,725. Best if savings matter most.

Buy in May

About 18% more country-home listings than August, at only a ~9% price premium.

Thank You

Questions & discussion

